JOHNEGGLESTONBALLYBUNIONEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're here in Khan in France and I've run into John Eggleston from the fabulous Ballybunion Golf Club in Ireland in County Kerry and welcome to the program. Thanks very much Jeff, thanks for having me. First of all tell us about Ballybunion, it's it's one of the premier golf courses and clubs in the whole of Ireland.

Yeah Ballybunion is one of the world's top 20 courses so we're very proud of our facilities we have in Ballybunion. We've got roughly two and a half thousand members, we have two courses, two links courses, one designed by Tom Watson, just recently renovated this year and the world famous old course which opened in 1893. So we do a lot of business with American, North American visitors every year and we have even have some Australians, New Zealand people from New Zealand.

We welcome about 20,000 visitors every year welcoming and very busy place. Now you're right on the north part of County Kerry on the west coast and you have a beautiful sea view here, tell us about the views that you can get when you're playing. Yeah so we're a links property so we're actually on the old course you can see the sea from every single golf hole.

On the cash-in course you can also see the sea and multiple golf holes so we're just adjacent like some of these courses the sea is a bit away like about a half mile whereas the Ballybunion you're actually right on the edge of the holes run right on the edge of the actual shore. So it lends itself being on the North Atlantic, it lends itself to spectacular sea views and slicked back to our sunsets as the sun sets in the west over the Atlantic Ocean. Next stop is the USA as I say that's the next point to land after Ballybunion as you look out to the out to the west.

And all the ships I suppose sailing out of the south of Ireland and sailing around there. Yeah we're at the mouth of the we're at the head of the mouth of the inlet of the ports up at the port of Fiennes. Tankers it's a big deep-sea port there in Fiennes so you get a lot of traffic coming up there you see a lot of back ships actually just more off the coast of Ballybunion because they got to pay holding charges in the port so they stay they flow they float outside there especially during the winter.

So yeah it's a good west coast of Ireland is a very unique environment since the don't come expecting great weather the weather is good can be in the very warm summer but you have to expect a bit of wind and a bit of rain as you know even can gets rain as you saw yesterday so we got a lot of it. Yeah certainly did we had almost a flood here in Caen yesterday but that's the beauty of Ireland because they call it the green emerald isle because you do get so much rain it really makes the ground beautiful on the beautiful days it's just stunning isn't it? Absolutely yeah I mean the scenery in Ireland is second to none I mean a lot of our visitors come and play five six seven golf courses a lot of visitors to come and visit the lakes of Killarney the cliffs of moor the fabulous scenic sites the beaches you know the ring of Kerry it's a fabulous tourist tourist area.

Ballybunion is a fantastic jumping-on point to the whole of the County Kerry isn't it there's so many things to do and see in the county.

Yeah absolutely there's plenty in Ballybunion you've got your cliffwalks you've got your seaweed bats you've got your two golf courses obviously and then you've got your plenty of walks plenty of swimming the surfing all of outdoor activities is really good. John Eggleston here from Ballybunion Golf Club what was your background before you got involved with the club were you in golf professionally or? No I was actually in retail pharmacy so I was a commercial director of a retail pharmacy group we had about partly stores and all around the country so I was just general operation management really pharmacists by profession so I joined the golf industry in about nine years ago 2007 my first job was in Ballybunion. And tell us about some if people are coming to Ballybunion a couple of the really must-see things to do in town or nearby apart from the resort itself you must have some little secret spots that you can tell us about.

Yeah I mean Ballybunion has this really good surfing it's quite famous on Whitley Hinch it's got really good surfing it also has seaweed bats which are a must-do for any local parts of the month to come theme famous seaweed bats in Ballybunion and it's got a lot of cliffwalks as well so there's a lot of history a lot of cliffwalks around the castle. Restaurants and whiskey places too? Yeah no we don't have any distillery in Ballybunion you need to go to Killarney for that but we have like a lot of restaurants in town especially very busy during the summer good seafood good food absolutely. Now Killarney castles very famous isn't it is that the one with where you kiss the Ballyney stone or not? Oh that's Blyarney no that's in the Blyarney stone there no Killarney is actually you've got the Bucharest house and you've got the lakes you've got Ross Castle different and other different tourist tracks you've got the lakes themselves a lot of boating on the lakes a lot of fishing as well and you've got the mountains and obviously where you can get the red deer so it's all that.

How can people find out more about Ballybunion Golf Club online? Ballybuniongolfclub.com that's that will get you onto our website you can book directly with us or you can actually go to tour operators and we'll I'm sure they'll be more than happy there's numerous them in Australia that are organizing packages to Ireland's well it's on the list of all keen Australian golfers on their trip to Ireland Scotland's do the south west to the northeast and go on to Scotland generally come for up to three weeks and these really big long golfing trips they're really love they love their golf the Australians. And you are true Irishman do you speak a bit of Gaelic yourself? Absolutely small. Can you say hello in Gaelic for our Irish speakers in Australia? To fall to the roads has been good best wishes and hello and you have workers to deers with with gods with gods help so it's very various fuckers so it's a long time before I speak Irish I'm kind of tongue tight now need to see what what is the workers of diesel with the help of God and we can say deers marigood can't you? Deers marigood is the best wishes and all that but workers of deers like workers of deers the the Ladina Maastral, Honixier, could be Ballybunion, Gimmurtz the golf.

Brilliant thank you so much for that John and it's been lovely talking to you and Ballybunion Golf

Club head over there it will be the most magnificent views and the best golf one of the best golf courses in the whole of Ireland thanks so very much for being on the program. Thanks Jeff thank you